



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/2058/2025/J-15

Name and address of the complainant : **Mr. Muhammad Imran Shakeel**
R/o Flat No. 101, Building 29-C, Ittehad Lane-6, Phase-VI, D.H.A., Karachi.

Name of the Agency Complained against : **Boards & Universities Department / SHEC**

Name & Designation of Investigating Officer : **Dr. Syed Sharaf Ali Shah, Advisor-J**

Vetted by :

Subject : **COMPLAINT REGARDING ALLEGED DELAY IN VERIFICATION OF DEGREE OF THE COMPLAINANT BY PIMSAT (PASSED IN THE YEAR 2004) FOR WANT OF HUGE AMOUNT**

COMPLAINT

Mr. Muhammad Imran Shakeel filed a complaint via e-mail dated 18.03.2025, alleging an inordinate delay in verification of his degree by Preston Institute of Management Science & Technology (PIMSAT), Karachi. The complainant stated that he passed his degree in the year 2004 however, despite multiple visits to the University, the concerned officials avoided verification of his degree and demanded a huge amount as bribe. He, therefore, sought the intervention of this Institution.

PROCEEDINGS

2. The complaint was admitted under Section 10 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (as amended up-to-date), subject to submission of the mandatory affidavit on Form "A", copy of CNIC, and by condoning the delay.
3. After completion of codal formalities, the matter was taken up with the Agency, i.e., Sindh Higher Education Commission, and the Vice Chancellor, Preston Institute of Management Science & Technology, Karachi, vide letter dated 10.04.2025, for comments and report. In response, the Deputy Director, PIMSAT Karachi, submitted a report dated 24.04.2025 stating that the complainant approached the Institution for verification of his degree and, upon scrutiny of record, the degree was found fake. As per the record of the Institution, Mr. Muhammad Imran Shakeel was enrolled in the MBA program in the year 2003 however, he failed to pay the full tuition fee and related dues

for the said year. Furthermore, he did not submit the required thesis for his final examination and also failed in one subject of the final semester. In view of the foregoing, PIMSAT Karachi stated that no degree could have been awarded to the complainant.

4. Meanwhile, the Director (CIEC), Sindh Higher Education Commission, Charter Inspection & Evaluation Committee, submitted a report dated 05.05.2025, stating that after a comprehensive review of the issue, both parties were directed to appear before the Director (CIEC) on 29.04.2025 for resolution of the matter. The complainant appeared before the Director (CIEC) on 02.05.2025 and produced all original documents, including transcripts, degree, convocation photographs, and convocation entrance cards. However, no representative of PIMSAT Karachi attended the proceedings. Furthermore, multiple hearings were subsequently conducted by the Investigation Officer, including the last two hearings held on 04.08.2025 and 20.10.2025, which were attended by both parties. During these hearings, the complainant again produced all original documents, including transcripts, degree, convocation photographs, and convocation entrance cards but the Agency remained silent and failed to respond. The representative of the Agency stated that the Agency had already submitted its report and that no further report would be furnished.

5. Subsequently, an additional report / legal opinion dated 18.12.2025 was submitted by the Assistant Director (M&E), Sindh Higher Education Commission, wherein it was stated that the Rector, Preston Institute of Management Sciences and Technology (PIMSAT), objected to the proposed inspection by the Sindh Higher Education Commission on the ground that a case was pending before the Islamabad High Court.

6. The said report clarified as under:

- i. The pending case before the Islamabad High Court was instituted by the Federal Higher Education Commission and not by PIMSAT; therefore, PIMSAT is not a contesting party in the said proceedings.
- ii. No restraining or interim order has been passed by the Islamabad High Court prohibiting inspections or regulatory actions concerning PIMSAT.
- iii. The proposed inspection is a routine statutory function of the Charter Inspection & Evaluation Committee (CIEC) and does not constitute a punitive or inquiry measure.

iv. Sindh Higher Education Commission is neither a party to nor involved in the proceedings before the Islamabad High Court.

v. PIMSAT remains a valid chartered institution, as its charter has neither been revoked nor suspended.

7. The aforesaid report was forwarded to the complainant for rejoinder. In his response, the complainant reiterated that he appeared before the Director (CIEC) on the scheduled date and time along with all original documents; however, no progress was made in the matter, which remains pending. He further alleged that PIMSAT Karachi submitted vague and false excuses and deliberately avoided appearing before any forum. The complainant requested that PIMSAT be directed to verify his degree without any further delay.

FINDINGS

8. Based on the investigation and available documentary evidence, it is concluded that:-
- i) The conduct of the PIMSAT in the matter of verification of the complainant's MBA degree appears evasive and lacking transparency. Even if the complainant was allegedly ineligible for the award of the MBA degree on the grounds cited by the University, such assertions required proper substantiation through record and reasoned justification, which has not been provided.
 - ii) The refusal of the PIMAST to allow SHEC to inspect its campus and academic records on the pretext of a pending matter before the Hon'ble Islamabad High Court reflects an attempt to obstruct lawful oversight and raises serious concerns regarding possible mismanagement and irregularities in the maintenance of academic records of its graduated students.
 - iii) Mere pendency of a case before a court of law does not, in itself, place any embargo on a statutory regulatory authority from performing its lawful and mandated functions, unless specifically restrained by a competent court through an express order.
 - iv) SHEC, in discharge of its statutory and fiduciary responsibilities, is under a legal obligations to intervene, oversee, and investigate the academic affairs of the University, particularly where allegations pertain to denial of degree verification to a student who completed the MBA program in 2004.
 - v) The continued non-cooperation and failure of the PIMSAT to facilitate SHEC in the exercise of its statutory mandate amounts to maladministration warranting appropriate corrective and disciplinary action in accordance with the applicable law.

DECISION

9. In view of the above findings, the complaint is disposed of. However, in exercise of powers conferred under Section 11 of the Establishment of the Office of Ombudsman for the Province of Sindh Act, 1991 (as amended up-to-date), the following directions are hereby issued to the Secretary, Boards & Universities Department, Government of Sindh, Karachi, and the Vice Chancellor, PIMSAT Karachi:

- i. Ensure immediate verification of the degree of the complainant, Mr. Muhammad Imran Shakeel.
 - ii. Initiate a departmental enquiry to fix responsibility upon the delinquent officers/officials of PIMSAT Karachi for delaying the matter. The Secretary, Sindh Higher Education Commission, Karachi, is further advised to conduct an inspection visit and take necessary action by engaging the relevant officers / officials to investigate and resolve issues relating to degree verification cases.
 - iii. Submit a compliance report to this Office within ninety (90) days.
10. The complaint is disposed of as **redressed** and consigned to record.

"Given under my hand and seal of office"



Sd /-
(Muhammad Sohail Rajput)
Sitara-e-Imtiaz. PAS
Ombudsman, Sindh
Karachi, dated 30th January, 2026